

next newer car, the next fashionable styles, or the next hot fad. Sidewalkers are carelessly trapped in a “Lifestyle Servitude” fed by an urgent, insatiable need for pleasure, image, and instant gratification. This perpetuates a cascading cycle that spins faster every month, increasing the velocity of the burden, forever enslaving the Sidewalker to their job or their business.

The Sidewalk is the road most traveled because it’s the path of least resistance. Its siren song is instant gratification, and money is a hot potato that’s quickly exchanged for the latest fix of the day. Want to witness how Sidewalkers live and think? Watch the television show *Judge Judy* for a few hours. Daughters suing moms for \$100, people denying responsibility, consequence ignorance, people wanting rent for free. Seriously, the show should be renamed *Life from the Sidewalk*.

THE MINDPOSTS OF A SIDEWALKER

The Sidewalker’s roadmap contains behavioral characteristics that drive the Sidewalker’s actions. These mindsets are signposts, or “mindposts” that guide the Sidewalker through life.

Debt Perception: *Credit allows me to buy things now! Credit cards, consolidation loans, car payments—these supplement my income and help me enjoy life today! If I want it now, I’m going to get it now.*

Time Perception: *Time is abundant and I spend money like there’s no tomorrow. Heck, I could be dead in two weeks, and you can’t take it with you!*

Education Perception: *I finished school when I graduated, hooray!*

Money Perception: *If you got it, flaunt it! Why save for a rainy day? I spend every dime I earn and most of my bills are paid on time; isn’t that being fiscally responsible?*

Primary Income Source: *Whatever gig pays the most is what I will do. I chase money baby! It’s all about the Benjamins!*

Primary Wealth Accelerator: *Net worth? I hit the casino, I buy lottery tickets, and I have an active lawsuit against an insurance company . . . does that count?*

Wealth Perception: *He who dies with the most toys wins!*

Wealth Equation: *My formula for wealth is (Wealth = Income + Debt).*

Destination: *What destination? I live for today and I can’t be bothered about tomorrow.*